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THE K. PATRICIA CROSS ACADEMY

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## Activity 3.1: You Might Be a Constructivist If Inventory

There are many different theories of learning, and it is easy to be overwhelmed by the sheer amount of information about them. However, understanding the different theories of learning and considering which of them most closely aligns with your own views can better inform your teaching. The You Might Be a Constructivist If Inventory is an informal assessment intended to help you identify your own views of learning and ascertain where they fall within the primary existing theoretical frameworks. Clarifying your theoretical stance can help you express your views to others and best direct your teaching efforts going forward.

**In your opinion, which of the following is the best definition of learning?**

- [x] An individualized pursuit in which students internalize learned concepts, principles and rules and apply them in the real world
- [ ] An observable change in behavior
- [ ] A permanent alteration in learners' brains
- [ ] A personal act

**What do you see as the goal of student learning in your class?**

- [ ] Learning to provide the correct or best response
- [x] Processing information; organizing new information within pre-existing schema
- [ ] Fulfilling student learning needs
- [ ] Creating and sharing new information

**Which of the following do you think is the most important task for your work as a teacher?**

- ○ Facilitating development of the whole person
- ● Creating learning environments that deliberately engage different thought processes, offering students effective mental learning strategies, and teaching students to effectively organize information
- ○ Facilitating active learning that is conducive to teamwork and reflection
- ○ Providing students with reinforcement, such as grade bonuses or point penalties, to facilitate learning

**Which of the following teacher processes would you most likely adopt to improve student learning in your course?**

- ○ Use repetition to reinforce learning so that students benefit from multiple opportunities to practice new skills and demonstrate understanding
- ○ Create authentic learning environments and activities and encourage self-reflection about learning
- ○ Seek to understand a student's stage of development and meet them where they are
- ● Work to structure and sequence learning activities to mimic real-world experiences, so that students are encouraged to select, interpret, and create meaning from the classroom

**Which of the following do you believe is the most important role for learners in your class?**

- ○ Active participant in construction of knowledge
- ○ Respond to extrinsic motivation
- ○ Explore and observe
- ☑ Mental engagement in the tasks

**Which of the following do you think is most important for students to do to be successful in your class?**

- ☑ Be prepared to learn to process new information
- ○ Complete an authentic task with personal significance
- ○ Learn to respond best to the learning activities and assignments you have developed
- ○ Take responsibility for their learning

**Which of the following activities are you most likely to use in your class?**

- [x] Personal goal setting, self-directed learning, reflective practice
- [ ] Self-directed quest for knowledge, collaborative learning
- [ ] Pre-tests, lectures, comprehension checks, practice and repetition, multiple-choice tests
- [ ] Concept mapping, analogies, and metaphors; substantive feedback; essays

**Scores**

**Behaviorism: 0**

You may find yourself selecting pedagogical activities that prioritize observable behavior, external rewards or punishments, and repetition to reinforce learning. This theory posits that human behavior can be explained in terms of conditioning, without appeal to thoughts or feelings, and that psychological disorders are best treated by altering behavior patterns.

**Cognitivism: 4**

You may choose pedagogical activities that focus on mental processes involved in learning, such as information processing, memory, and cognitive load. This theory emphasizes the processes involved in learning rather than on the observed behavior.

**Constructivism: 2**

You may select pedagogical activities that prioritize learners actively constructing knowledge through their experiences, reflection, and collaboration. This theory asserts that learners construct knowledge rather than just passively take in information.

**Humanism: 1**

You may prioritize learners as individuals and select activities that emphasize their subjective experiences, autonomy, and personal growth. This theory emphasizes the value and agency of human beings, individually and collectively.

Congratulations on completion of activity 3.1: You Might Be a Constructivist If Inventory.

To complete the formal process a self-reflection has been included. Are you interested in completing a self-reflection on this activity?

- ○ Yes, I will complete the self-assessment
- ☑ No, I am not interested in completing the self-assessment; please provide my output